

RAMAYANA: THE EPIC OF DHARMA

A Brief Summary of the Seven Kands (Books)

1. Bala Kand (The Book of Youth)

This chapter describes the birth of Lord Rama to King Dasharatha of Ayodhya. It covers his education, the slaying of demons like Tadaka, and his marriage to Sita, the daughter of King Janaka, after breaking the divine bow of Lord Shiva.

2. Ayodhya Kand (The Book of Ayodhya)

Preparations for Rama's coronation are made, but Queen Kaikeyi, influenced by Manthara, asks for two boons: the exile of Rama for 14 years and the crowning of her son Bharata. Rama accepts this and leaves for the forest with Sita and Lakshmana.

3. Aranya Kand (The Book of the Forest)

The trio lives in the forest. The demoness Surpanakha is humiliated by Lakshmana. This leads to Ravana, the King of Lanka, kidnapping Sita by tricking Rama with a golden deer. Rama begins his search for Sita.

4. Kishkindha Kand (The Book of the Monkey Kingdom)

Rama meets Hanuman and Sugriva. He helps Sugriva defeat Vali and regain his kingdom. In return, Sugriva pledges his Vanar Sena (monkey army) to help find Sita. Hanuman is sent to the south.

5. Sundara Kand (The Book of Beauty)

Hanuman flies across the ocean to Lanka. He finds Sita in the Ashok Vatika. He gives her Rama's ring and reassures her. Before leaving, he burns a large part of Lanka and returns with news of Sita's location.

6. Yuddha Kand (The Book of War)

Rama and the army build a bridge (Ram Setu) across the sea. A fierce battle takes place in Lanka. Rama kills Ravana, Sita is rescued, and they return to Ayodhya as the 14-year exile ends.

7. Uttara Kand (The Book of the Last Chapter)

Rama is crowned King, marking the beginning of 'Ram Rajya' (the ideal state). The chapter also discusses the later lives of the brothers and their final departure from the mortal world.

Victory of Dharma over Adharma.